



CLONE DRONE HARMAN BAWEJA, 28

Stumbled, trying to do a Hrithik Roshan in *Love Story 2050*. Will now be seen in *Victory* playing an ace cricketer.

WE SAY Get rid of the '90s hair and dude, stop saying dude



SONG SUNG BLUE NEIL NITIN MUKESH, 26

Wowed the few who saw him as the sweet-faced murderer in *Johnny Gaddar*. Will soon be seen in several edgy movies.

WE SAY Smart. Despite the loverboy looks, he played against type.

The past six months have seen debuts by several young men but the race to be Bollywood's next It Boy is still wide open

Wohi Sikandar (JJWS), has produced JTYJN, and his imprint is all over it, from a scene where Imran breaks down and cries on his mother's shoulder (remember Aamir and Dalip Tahlil in *qsqr?*) to the best friend-turned-lover of JJWS. Imran plays Jai Singh Rathore, whose entry into the film is not via a flashy set of wheels but more mundanely at his desk, his studies interrupted by a phone call. His room has no posters of Britney Spears, only bikes, and a good time for him is not a one-on-one with his X-Box but a picnic with friends in

Igatpuri or a party at a pal's place—both staples of the '60s films, usually starring Shammi Kapoor and usually directed by Imran's grandfather, Nasir Hussain.

In an increasingly crowded marketplace, it may well be that young men, usually dynasty's children, looking to make a mark, will have to stand out. Their families can help them, but only up to a point, ensuring their presence on popular shows (witness Imran's appearance with Aamir on Salman Khan's *Dus ka Dum*), organising all-star premieres (from Madhuri Dixit to Govinda for the preview of *Jimmy*, starring Mithun Chakraborty's son, Mimoh), and managing cameos (like an item song by Sanjay Dutt for friend Sikander's debut *Woodstock Villa*). But

lingers on the debutant, are making way for the offbeat. Which explains why Neil Nitin Mukesh's charmingly murderous debut in *Johnny Gaddar* was so talked about. Which also explains why there is a buzz around director Farhan Akhtar's debut as an actor in *Rock On*, where he plays one of four rock band members who reunite after 10 years, opting out of their boring lives. Since it's a Farhan movie, it will be about the hair, but it will also have music, male bonding and man-woman relationships. And clearly, being the world's oldest newcomer at 34 hasn't affected Farhan as he's acting again in his sister's forthcoming *Luck by Chance*.

In keeping with Bollywood tradition, these boys are dynasty's children, of various kinds. There's Sikander, son of Kirron Kher, who debuted in *Woodstock Villa* and *Summer 2007*; Mimoh, who proved Pappu could dance but do little else in *Jimmy*; and Adhyayan Suman, son of actor Shekhar Suman, who made his debut last month in *Haal-e-Dil*, opposite another Bollywood offspring, Amrita Pathak, daughter of producer and Ajay Devgan buddy Kumar Mangat. Pappus all. But which one of them will pass? ■

LOOKING FOR A NICHE SIKANDER, 28

Played macho man in *Woodstock Villa* and rich kid in *Summer 2007*. Neither film worked.

WE SAY Needs to step out of the line and play to his unconventional strengths

